

slew all the men whom they found in it, and left not a single one remaining in it: they slew all in torments because they had dishonoured their sister Dinah. 5. And thus let it not again be done from henceforth that a daughter of Israel be defiled; for judgment is ordained in heaven against them that they should destroy with the sword all the men of the Shechemites because they had wrought shame in Israel. 6. And the Lord delivered them into the hands of the sons of Jacob that they might exterminate them with the sword and execute judgment upon them, and that it might not thus again be done in Israel that a virgin of Israel should be defiled. 7. And if there is any man who wishes in Israel to give his daughter or his sister to any man who is of the seed of the Gentiles he shall surely die, and they shall stone him with stones; for he hath wrought shame in Israel; and they shall burn the woman with fire, because she has dishonoured the name of the house of her father, and she shall be rooted out of Israel. 8. And let not an adulteress and no uncleanness be found in Israel throughout all the days of the generations of the earth; for Israel is holy unto the Lord, and every man who has defiled (it) shall surely die: they shall stone him with stones. 9. For thus has it been ordained and written in the heavenly tables regarding all the seed of Israel: he

5. *Wrought shame in Israel.* Cf. Gen. xxxiv. 7.

7. This statement does not agree quite with any in the O.T. The burning of the woman with fire, it is true, finds a precedent in Gen. xxxviii. 24, where Judah demands that such a punishment should be executed on Tamar—a punishment at variance with the later law in Lev. xxi. 9. See in note on xli. 17 the distortion of the biblical tradition had recourse to by the Rabbis in order to justify the demand of Judah. It is true that her crime is that of fornication, whereas our text deals merely with the marriage of a Hebrew woman and a Gentile. To

our author, however, such a marriage was illegal and was no better than fornication. In Lev. xxi. 9 it is ordained that a priest's daughter who played the harlot was to be burnt with fire. Our text teaches that to give a daughter to a non-Israelite was to give her to Moloch (cf. ver. 10). Since our author holds the former to be equivalent to the latter, it follows that the man who was guilty of the former offence should justly be visited with the penalty exacted for the latter, and this was, according to Lev. xx. 2, death by stoning; hence our text ordains: "and they shall stone him with stones."